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NAAMII UDAAN Monthly Report - October 2026

Report	October 2026
Name of the Organization	Nepal Applied Mathematics and Informatics Institute for Research (NAAMII)
Project	UDAAN – Unleashing Digital Acceleration and Ambition of Nepali Youth
Start date	April 2026
End date	April 2029
Reporting period	October 2026
Reported by	NAAMII

Progress during the reporting period (highlights)

1. NAAMII delivered two AI Native cohorts in October, reaching 80 participants at Manmohan Institute of Health Science (8 October) and Lord Buddha Education Foundation (LBEF), Maitidevi (12 October), bringing the total trained since July to 531.
2. NAAMII is in talks with the industry department at Singha Durbar.
3. An MoU between NAAMII and Budhanilkantha Municipality is in progress.
4. NAAMII has opened a call for an open cohort and will deliver pilot training to an online cohort, ISMT College, Uniglobe College and Global College. Training for MBL Bank and NEA is being planned.
5. The AI Native concept note and detailed training document (objectives, course structure, delivery methodology, duration and certification process) were shared with a college partner on 29 October to support further collaboration.
6. Sumi Dhakal joined the UDAAN team as Project Manager in October, and weekly PIT and UDAAN Platform meetings continued.

Detailed program progress as per workplan

Output 1.1: Digital skills and knowledge strengthened among young women and men, entrepreneurs, government officials, and CSO/CBOs

Activity 1.1.1: AI School Offering Tiered Hybrid Courses

During October 2026, NAAMII continued regular AI Native cohort delivery, with two cohorts reaching 80 participants (531 trained in total since July). In parallel, NAAMII progressed partnership discussions with the industry department at Singha Durbar and an MoU with Budhanilkantha Municipality, and prepared the next round of trainings with colleges, an online cohort and public and private sector institutions. AI Foundation and AI Deep remained at the preparation stage.

Detailed activities and progress:

- Eleventh cohort, Manmohan Institute of Health Science. Delivered on 8 October 2026 at Soalteemode to 42 participants, covering AI Native work practices, the AI Skills Pyramid and responsible use through demonstrations and practical examples.
- Twelfth cohort, Lord Buddha Education Foundation (LBEF). Delivered on 12 October 2026 at LBEF, Maitidevi to 38 participants.
- Open cohort. NAAMII opened a call for an open cohort for the public; onboarding of participants is under way.
- Online cohort. A pilot training will be delivered to an online cohort, extending AI School reach to learners beyond in-person venues in the Kathmandu Valley.

- College trainings. Trainings are to be delivered at ISMT College, Uniglobe College and Global College.
- Institutional trainings. Training for MBL Bank (private sector) and NEA (public sector) is being planned.
- Trainer recruitment. Applications for AI Native and AI Foundation trainer roles continued to be screened. [7 shortlisted]
- Tangible certificate and skill-map customization, after holidays.
- Online delivery artifact, also after holidays (Nov 30).

Cohort summary, October 2026

#	Date	Institution / Group	Venue	Participants	Participant group
11th	8 Oct 2026	Manmohan Institute of Health Science	Soalteemode	42	Health Background
12th	12 Oct 2026	Lord Buddha Education Foundation (LBEF)	LBEF, Maitidevi	38	Mixed (IT, Engineers)
		Total documented in October		**80**	

Total trained so far (July – October 2026)

Period	Participants trained
July – August 2026 (as reported in the August report)	280
September 2026 (as carried in the October update)	171
October 2026	80
Cumulative total	**531**

Partnerships in progress

Partner	Type	Status
Industry department, Singha Durbar	Government	In talks
Budhanilkantha Municipality	Local government	MoU in progress

Upcoming trainings

Cohort / Organisation	Type	Status
Open cohort	Open to the public	Onboarding
Online cohort	Online learners	Pilot training to be delivered
ISMT College	College	Training to be delivered
Uniglobe College	College	Training to be delivered
Global College	College	Training to be delivered
MBL Bank	Private sector	Training to be delivered
NEA	Public sector	Training to be delivered

Unfinished follow-ups carried into November:

- Complete the Tangible certificate and skill-map customisation (tech group), targeted after Chhath / third or fourth week of November 2026.

- Complete and test the online delivery artifact and run the online cohort pilot.
- Consolidate attendance, gender-disaggregated and completion records for all October cohorts, and verify the September figure carried in cumulative totals (171 in the October update versus 186 documented in the September report).

Output 2.3: Opportunities for professional experience created for young women and men

Activity 2.3.1: Internships and fellowships in the private sector

Work under the internships and fellowships activity remained preparatory ahead of the planned December 2026 start. No internship or fellowship placements were initiated during October.

Status of October commitments

October commitment (from September plan)	Status	Remarks
Deliver October AI Native cohorts and consolidate records	Largely completed	Two cohorts documented (MMIHS 8 Oct, LBEF 12 Oct), 80 participants; record consolidation continuing
MIT College Nepal open cohort (8 Oct) and Rotary Kathmandu session	In progress	Not covered in the October update; confirm whether delivered or rescheduled
Complete Tangible certificate and skill-map customisation	In progress	Due before Chhath (first week of November 2026)
Finalise online delivery artifact and pilot online sessions	In progress	Pilot training to an online cohort is being prepared
Convert priority MoU drafts into signed agreements	In progress	Budhanilkantha Municipality MoU in progress; other partner follow-ups
Validate Karmashala company shortlist and problem intake	In progress	Planned December 2026 start
Sector-wise coverage of AI Native cohorts	In progress	Open cohort, colleges, MBL Bank (fintech) and NEA (government) in preparation

Finance

(Any significant overspends and/or underspends in relation to the workplan, and any foreseeable impacts on forecast spend for the following period and FY)

- Programme and finance teams continued coordination on reporting and supporting documentation for October cohort delivery.
- The October expenditure, variance and forecast position will be reported through the accompanying financial report; no unverified overspend or underspend position is asserted in this program report.

Communication

(Any upcoming events and publications)

- Opened a call for an open cohort for the public.
- Shared the AI Native concept note and training details with a college partner (29 October).
- Upcoming communication priorities include the announcement of the online AI Native cohort, onboarding communication for the open cohort, and event reports with photographs for the October cohorts.

Risk levels

Any changes in risk levels (likelihood and/or impact) and, if so, the mitigations required? Any new risks?

- No major change in the overall risk level was identified.
- The pending Tangible certificate remains a minor timing dependency for certification reporting; mitigated by the tech group's committed completion and continued evidence collection.
- MoU timelines depend on partner approval processes (for example Budhanilkantha Municipality); mitigated through regular follow-up.
- Reliance on in-person venues limits reach beyond the Kathmandu Valley; the online cohort pilot and delivery artifact address this.

Coherence/Coordination

- Continued Tangible coordination through weekly UDAAN Platform meetings on skill mapping, certification, the learner community and the pathway toward verified competency.
- Progressed partnerships across sectors: talks with the industry department at Singha Durbar; MoU with Budhanilkantha Municipality in progress; training discussions with ISMT College, Uniglobe College, Global College, MBL Bank and NEA.
- Continued weekly PIT meetings (13, 20 and 27 October), daily EU UDAAN EOD check-ins, workplan tracking and reporting preparation, and welcomed Sumi Dhakal as Project Manager.
- Submitted the September 2026 monthly report and maintained visibility alignment with the wider consortium.

Plan for next month

- Deliver the open cohort, the online cohort pilot, and AI Native trainings at ISMT College, Uniglobe College and Global College.
- Finalise plans and deliver training for MBL Bank and NEA.
- Advance the Budhanilkantha Municipality MoU towards signing and continue talks with the industry department at Singha Durbar; follow up other partners awaiting confirmation.
- Complete the Tangible certificate and skill-map customisation after Chhath (fourth week of November 2026).
- Finalise the online delivery artifact and run out-of-valley cohorts for distant learners.
- Continue the sector-wise approach, aiming for at least one cohort in each of the nine sectors and collecting learner feedback from every cohort to develop sector-wise AI Native modules.
- Validate the Karmashala company shortlist and focal contacts and establish the problem-intake process ahead of the planned December 2026 start.
- Develop the AI Foundation modules, cohorts and learning pathways, and launch the AI Foundation module if the pilots work well.
- Consolidate attendance, gender-disaggregated and completion records for October cohorts.